

Male Neutered Cat Spraying Guide — Action Checklist

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RECOGNIZE MEDICAL EMERGENCY SIGNS

- ☐ **Recognize the emergency warning signs in your neutered male cat, including straining to urinate with little output, crying in the litter box, excessive licking of the genital area, hiding, lethargy, or a hard distended abdomen, because these indicate a potentially life-threatening urinary blockage that can kill your cat within 24-48 hours.:** Recognize the emergency warning signs in your neutered male cat, including straining to urinate with little output, crying in the litter box, excessive licking of the genital area, hiding, lethargy, or a hard distended abdomen, because these indicate a potentially life-threatening urinary blockage that can kill your cat within 24-48 hours.
- ☐ **Understand that neutered male cats have a longer and narrower urethra than females or intact males, making them uniquely susceptible to dangerous blockages from urinary crystals, sludge, or protein plugs that cause fatal kidney failure without immediate veterinary intervention.:** Understand that neutered male cats have a longer and narrower urethra than females or intact males, making them uniquely susceptible to dangerous blockages from urinary crystals, sludge, or protein plugs that cause fatal kidney failure without immediate veterinary intervention.
- ☐ **Treat any sudden onset of spraying or litter box avoidance in your neutered male as a medical symptom requiring urgent veterinary evaluation, not a behavioral problem, because feline lower urinary tract disease often manifests as inappropriate urination before classic obstruction signs become obvious.:** Treat any sudden onset of spraying or litter box avoidance in your neutered male as a medical symptom requiring urgent veterinary evaluation, not a behavioral problem, because feline lower urinary tract disease often manifests as inappropriate urination before classic obstruction signs become obvious.
- ☐ **Go to the vet tonight if your cat shows any emergency signs, because waiting even 24 hours can result in irreversible kidney damage or death from a complete urinary blockage in a male cat.:** Go to the vet tonight if your cat shows any emergency signs, because waiting even 24 hours can result in irreversible kidney damage or death from a complete urinary blockage in a male cat.

PREPARE FOR DIAGNOSTIC VET VISIT

- ❑ **Request a complete diagnostic panel from your veterinarian including urinalysis, urine culture, abdominal palpation, blood chemistry, and a full physical exam to identify medical causes of spraying before treating it as a behavioral issue.:** Request a complete diagnostic panel from your veterinarian including urinalysis, urine culture, abdominal palpation, blood chemistry, and a full physical exam to identify medical causes of spraying before treating it as a behavioral issue.
- ❑ **Ask your veterinarian specifically whether your cat's crystals are calcium oxalate or struvite, because calcium oxalate is more common in middle-aged neutered male cats and requires different dietary and medical management than struvite crystals.:** Ask your veterinarian specifically whether your cat's crystals are calcium oxalate or struvite, because calcium oxalate is more common in middle-aged neutered male cats and requires different dietary and medical management than struvite crystals.
- ❑ **Ask your veterinarian whether your cat's bladder wall is thickened, because bladder wall changes indicate chronic feline lower urinary tract disease that requires ongoing medical management beyond acute treatment.:** Ask your veterinarian whether your cat's bladder wall is thickened, because bladder wall changes indicate chronic feline lower urinary tract disease that requires ongoing medical management beyond acute treatment.
- ❑ **Request a urine culture even if the initial urinalysis dipstick looks normal, because subclinical bacterial infections hide in standard tests and are a common cause of spraying that only shows up in culture results.:** Request a urine culture even if the initial urinalysis dipstick looks normal, because subclinical bacterial infections hide in standard tests and are a common cause of spraying that only shows up in culture results.

FIX LITTER BOX AND CLEANING SETUP

- ❑ **Verify your litter box is large enough by measuring 1.5 times your cat's body length in both dimensions, because a male cat needs room to turn around fully without touching the sides, especially when dealing with urinary issues.:** Verify your litter box is large enough by measuring 1.5 times your cat's body length in both dimensions, because a male cat needs room to turn around fully without touching the sides, especially when dealing with urinary issues.

- ☐ **Switch to an open-top litter box filled with 2 inches of unscented, fine-grained, clumping litter, because covered boxes trap ammonia and feel claustrophobic to a stressed male cat, and fragrances can trigger sensitivity in cats with urinary issues.:** Switch to an open-top litter box filled with 2 inches of unscented, fine-grained, clumping litter, because covered boxes trap ammonia and feel claustrophobic to a stressed male cat, and fragrances can trigger sensitivity in cats with urinary issues.

- ☐ **Apply the n+1 rule for litter box quantity by providing one more box than the number of cats in your home, with at least one box on each floor, because resource competition and multi-level access are common triggers for territorial spraying behavior.:** Apply the n+1 rule for litter box quantity by providing one more box than the number of cats in your home, with at least one box on each floor, because resource competition and multi-level access are common triggers for territorial spraying behavior.

- ☐ **Use an enzymatic cleaner specifically formulated for cat spray, applying it generously and letting it sit for 10-15 minutes before blotting, because standard cleaners mask the smell to humans but leave behind pheromone signals that tell your cat this is claimed territory.:** Use an enzymatic cleaner specifically formulated for cat spray, applying it generously and letting it sit for 10-15 minutes before blotting, because standard cleaners mask the smell to humans but leave behind pheromone signals that tell your cat this is claimed territory.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.